

Figurative Language - Workbook 3

Focused practice - Workbook 3 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each short text closely. Answer without checking the key. Then compare your reasoning with the explanation and mark the mistake type if you were wrong.

Before you start

- Underline or mentally mark the exact wording that controls your answer.
- Do not choose an option just because it is true in general; it must fit this text.
- After checking, write one sentence explaining why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Practice Room

Her first attempt at the difficult passage was a staircase with missing steps: the melody moved forward, then broke apart whenever she reached the fastest measures.

1. What does the comparison mean?

- A. The music advanced unevenly with gaps.
- B. The room had a damaged staircase.
- C. She practiced while walking upstairs.
- D. The melody became quieter.

2. What effect does the image create?

- A. It makes the uneven progress easy to visualize.
- B. It proves the piece is old.
- C. It explains music theory.
- D. It makes the musician seem angry.

Storm Drain

During the cloudburst, the street drains swallowed water until leaves blocked the grates.

3. What does swallowed suggest?

- A. The drains took in large amounts of water.
- B. The drains became animals.
- C. The water disappeared permanently.
- D. The grates opened wider.

4. What changes when swallowed is replaced with received?

- A. The sentence becomes less vivid and forceful.
- B. The amount of water becomes exact.
- C. The leaves disappear.
- D. The drain becomes wider.

First Day

The new schedule looked like a maze until Jordan marked each room on a campus map.

5. What does maze suggest?

- A. The schedule initially seemed confusing and difficult to navigate.
- B. The schedule contained a puzzle game.
- C. Jordan got physically trapped.
- D. The campus had no signs.

6. Why does the later map detail matter?

- A. It reinforces the navigation comparison.
- B. It proves the schedule was printed.
- C. It changes the time of classes.
- D. It makes Jordan dislike maps.

Answer key and reasoning

Practice Room

1. A. Missing steps represent the places where the performance breaks down.
2. A. The concrete staircase image helps the reader picture interrupted progress.

Storm Drain

3. A. The figurative verb makes the intake of water seem active and rapid.
4. A. Received is more neutral and does not create the same active image.

First Day

5. A. Maze transfers the idea of difficult navigation to understanding the schedule.
6. A. The literal act of mapping echoes the figurative maze and clarifies how Jordan solved the confusion.

Mistake review

- If you chose a familiar meaning that did not fit the context, label it wrong sense.
- If you chose an option based on one word but ignored the rest of the passage, label it one-clue trap.
- If you understood the basic meaning but missed attitude or effect, label it effect missed.
- Redo the question later without looking at the key.